



JAKE MICHAELS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Return to Form
The Los Angeles County Museum of Art’s new home opens soon, and our critic Michael Kimmelman is impressed. Page C1.

In Confronting Another Pope, Trump Finds a Harder Target

By ELIZABETH DIAS and MOTOKO RICH
WASHINGTON — Donald Trump ascended to office 10 years ago while publicly jousting with Pope Francis, who was routinely making headlines for the progressive Catholicism he elevated, pushing the Roman Catholic Church to focus on climate change and the rights of immigrants. The pope suggested that Mr. Trump was “not Christian”; Mr. Trump fired back that Francis was “disgraceful.”
Mr. Trump capitalized on growing discontent among conservative Christians and won the White House. The chasm only further

widened between the Vatican and conservative American Catholics, who often saw in Mr. Trump a champion.
Pope Leo XIV, who was elected less than a year ago, is not Francis. For Mr. Trump, who is now in his second term, he presents a new foil at the Vatican with a markedly different standing among Catholics. As the first American in the seat of St. Peter, he has a native fluency in American politics and culture, and his leadership is supported across

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Rare Israel and Lebanon Talks Focus on Curtailing Hezbollah

This article is by Michael Crowley, Euan Ward, Anushka Patil and Thomas Fuller.
WASHINGTON — Israeli and Lebanese officials held their first direct talks in decades on Tuesday, meeting in Washington to try to end a bloody conflict that has threatened to derail the broader cease-fire in the war between Iran and the United States.
“We understand we’re working against decades of history,” said Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who was involved in the talks.
Mr. Rubio said the negotiations had the ambitious goal of trying to bring “a permanent end to 20 or 30

years of Hezbollah influence in this part of the world.” Hezbollah, the Lebanese-based militant group allied with Iran, is not a part of the talks and has long opposed direct negotiations with Israel.
After a meeting that lasted more than two hours, Israel’s representative at the talks, Yechiel Leiter, said the two countries were “on the same side of the equation” and described the meeting as the “beginning” of an effort to defeat

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WARNING The war in Iran could slow growth, the International Monetary Fund projected. PAGE B1



PHOTOGRAPHS BY ERIN SCHAFF/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Child Care Crisis
With cuts closing centers, parents are facing hard choices. Above, the teacher Jovanna Perez at her day care on its last day. Page A12.

A Police Chief’s \$4.5 Million Gambling Secret: ‘It’s on the App’

By HURUBIE MEKO
NEW HAVEN, Conn. — Karl R. Jacobson had what seemed like a model law enforcement career. He rose through the ranks of the Police Department in New Haven, Conn., to become the police chief in 2022, around the same time he earned his master’s degree in criminal justice.
As he completed what appeared

to be a successful first term, he was on the cusp of reappointment. But those who worked closest to him had started spotting red flags.
In December, Mr. Jacobson asked one of his lieutenants for a \$500 loan. He took money set aside to pay informants and left behind an I.O.U. note. A department account he controlled was empty.
Three of his deputies con-

A Spotlight on the Risks of Online Betting

fronted him in January. When they gathered in Mr. Jacobson’s office, he explained that he was addicted to gambling. The deputies were confused. They had “never seen him gambling,” one

said, according to an arrest warrant.
Mr. Jacobson tapped his phone on a conference table. “It’s on the app,” he said. In a year he had wagered about \$4.46 million on DraftKings and FanDuel accounts, two of the nation’s leading online sports betting sites, according to investigators.
He retired within hours. A little

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Pulled From Brink of Collapse
Denmark is aiding Mykolaiv, Ukraine, as the Trump administration pushes a more business-focused plan. PAGE A4

Carney Seals a Majority
The Canadian leader’s remaking of the Liberal Party leaves him unmatched in domestic power. News Analysis. PAGE A7

NATIONAL A12-20
A Fight for the Youth Vote
A wide range of groups are competing against Turning Point USA on college campuses in what will be the first election since Charlie Kirk’s death. PAGE A13
Bessent Shrugs Off Science
The Treasury secretary said it was “difficult to deconstruct” the reasons for global warming. PAGE A19

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Creator of Zany Television
Sid Krofft, with his brother Marty, was behind shows like “H.R. Pufnstuf” and “Land of the Lost.” He was 96. PAGE B12



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Fast-Food Fight Over Drinks
McDonald’s is adding fruit-flavored cold beverages to compete with chains like Dunkin’ and Starbucks. PAGE B1

Examining A.I. Overviews
Google’s answers look authoritative, but they draw on sources from trustworthy sites to Facebook posts. PAGE B1

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Next-Generation Shortstops
A stellar crop of eye-popping phenoms is hitting the major leagues, driven by talent and by structural factors keeping them at the position. PAGE B6

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Lives of the Artists
The actors Ian McKellen, 86, and Michaela Coel, 38, star together in “The Christophers,” Steven Soderbergh’s new movie about fine art. PAGE C1

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KRISTIAN THACKER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

An A.I.-powered drone at a factory near Columbus, Ohio.

A Global Race For Arsenals Of A.I. Drones

This article is by Sheera Frenkel, Paul Mozur and Adam Satariano.
At a military parade in Beijing in September, President Xi Jinping and his special guests, President Vladimir V. Putin of Russia and the North Korean leader, Kim Jong-un, watched as Chinese forces showed off several models of drones that could autonomously fly alongside fighter jets into battle.
The demonstration of technological might immediately set off alarm bells in the United States. Pentagon officials concluded that America’s program for combat drones was lagging China’s, according to three U.S. defense and intelligence officials. Russia, too, was thought to be ahead in building facilities that could produce advanced drones, said the officials, who were not authorized to speak publicly on military capabilities.
U.S. officials pushed domestic defense companies to step up. Last month, Anduril, a defense technology start-up in California, began manufacturing A.I.

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FOOD D1-8
Big-Money Bets on Bagels
Exceptional bagels were once found only in a few major cities. Some investors are determined to make them a nationwide phenomenon. PAGE D8

